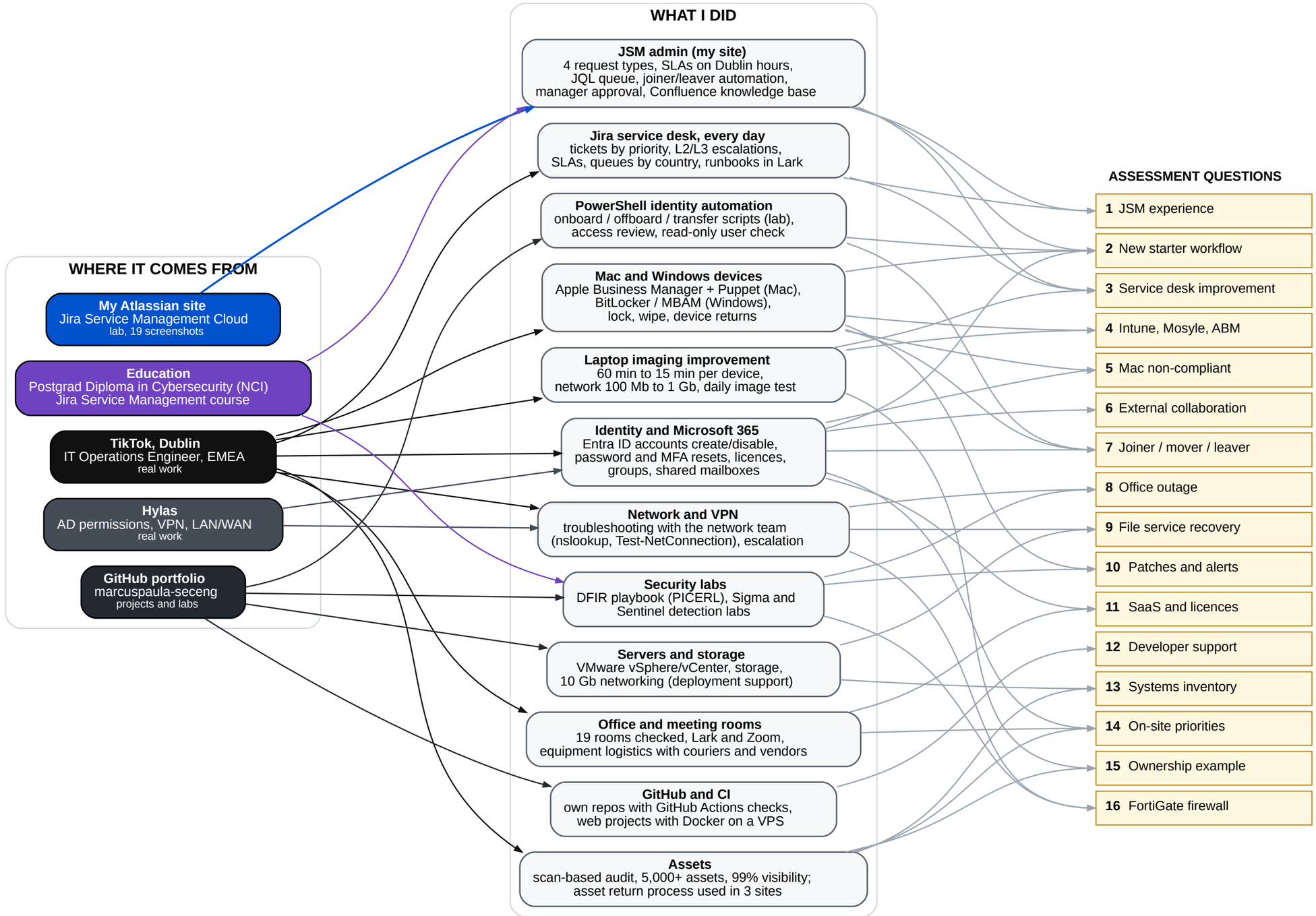
Marcus Paula: what I did, and how it answers the 16 questions

IT Operations Engineer (TikTok, Dublin, EMEA) · Senior IT Operations Engineer written assessment · github.com/marcuspaula-seceng

What the role asks for

Build and improve Jira / JSM	Confluence knowledge base	Mac and Windows management	Entra ID, M365, joiners and leavers	Security, firewall, network	Ownership and documentation
Q1 Q2 Q3	Q1	Q4 Q5 Q10	Q2 Q6 Q7	Q8 Q9 Q16	Q13 Q14 Q15



Black = real work at TikTok and Hylas · Blue = my Jira Service Management Cloud site · Dark grey = GitHub projects and labs · Purple = education. Labs use synthetic data and are labelled as labs.

Question by question

Real work, lab evidence, and what is new to me. Every link opens the project on my GitHub.

#	Question	Real work (TikTok / Hylas)	Lab evidence (Atlassian site / GitHub)	New to me / how I would approach it	Links
1	**JSM experience**	Jira every day as an agent: tickets by priority, L2/L3 escalations, SLAs, queues by country, runbooks in Lark. Admin team did the configuration.	Built my own JSM Cloud service desk: request types, SLAs, JQL queue, automation, approval, Confluence knowledge base. 19 screenshots.	JSM Assets, SSO/SCIM with Entra ID, large production instance. Learn in a sandbox first.	Project 07 JSM lab
2	**New starter workflow**	New starter process every week: Entra ID account, M365 licence and groups, laptop (ABM + Puppet for Mac, BitLocker for Windows).	One New starter request creates 4 sub-tasks (tested). Onboarding script takes the ticket number and runs in test mode first. Read-only check script.	Due dates, weekly queue and notifications are my proposal, not built yet.	Project 07 JSM lab Joiner/leaver runbook AD automation lab Read-only user check
3	**Service desk improvement**	Saw the move from one shared queue to queues by country with owners and SLAs. Imaging fix: measure, fix the root cause, make it repeatable.	JQL queue for unassigned tickets close to breach; SLAs on Dublin hours.	Inheriting a live JSM setup: review first, test in a sandbox, change one thing at a time.	Project 07 JSM lab Project 01 Imaging
4	**Intune, Mosyle, ABM**	Macs in Apple Business Manager + Puppet; Windows with BitLocker / MBAM; imaging server; lock, wipe, returns.	Tool mapping: what I used vs Intune / Jamf.	Intune and Mosyle not used directly. Same lifecycle; learn on test devices.	Project 08 Identity & devices Project 01 Imaging
5	**Mac non-compliant**	Sign-in, password and MFA issues every day, identity checked first.	Troubleshooting guide; read-only script shows licences, groups, MFA and devices.	Intune compliance and Conditional Access troubleshooting is new to me.	Troubleshooting guide Read-only user check
6	**External collaboration**	M365 groups, shared mailboxes; data-ownership transfer at offboarding only after authorisation.	-	Guest (B2B) access and sharing policies not set up by me. Test with one guest first.	Project 08 Identity & devices
7	**Joiner / mover / leaver**	Created and disabled Entra ID accounts, licences and groups; locked, wiped and collected devices.	PowerShell lab: onboard, transfer, offboard, access review, stale accounts (with tests). Joiner/leaver runbook.	HR system to Entra ID integration not built by me.	AD automation lab Joiner/leaver runbook Project 08 Identity & devices
8	**Office outage**	On-site network and VPN troubleshooting (nslookup, Test-NetConnection) and escalation to the network team. VPN and LAN/WAN at Hylas.	Incident response runbook and incident report template.	FortiGate hands-on is new to me.	DFIR playbook
9	**File service recovery**	Supported deployment of VMware, storage and 10 Gb networking.	-	QNAP is new to me. Same method: network, storage, access; restore to a separate place first.	Project 03 VMware
10	**Patches and alerts**	Kept laptop images current with a daily test; BitLocker compliance for Windows.	DFIR playbook; Sigma and Sentinel detection labs (lab only, no production claim).	Defender administration is new to me.	Project 01 Imaging DFIR playbook Windows detection lab Sentinel detection lab
11	**SaaS and licences**	Access and licence requests; M365 licences by group; Lark and Zoom in meeting rooms.	-	Slack, Adobe and Autodesk admin consoles are new to me.	Project 05 Meeting rooms
12	**Developer support**	-	Own GitHub repos with GitHub Actions checks; web projects with Docker on a VPS.	Jenkins and Parsec are new to me. Fix the IT side; platform owner changes the platform.	AD automation lab
13	**Systems inventory**	Scan-based asset audit, 5,000+ assets, 99% visibility, EMEA reference model. Asset return process in 3 sites.	ITAM/ITSM research with SQLite.	Business criticality and recovery docs per system: build one register + runbook template.	Project 02 Asset audit Project 04 Asset return Project 06 ITAM/ITSM
14	**On-site priorities**	Busy onboarding weeks; 19 meeting rooms checked; equipment logistics with couriers and vendors; device returns.	-	-	Project 05 Meeting rooms Project 04 Asset return
15	**Ownership example**	Imaging: 60 to 15 minutes per device, network 100 Mb to 1 Gb, daily image test, standard checklist.	-	Note: my recent role was hands-on, not consulting.	Project 01 Imaging
16	**FortiGate firewall**	Firewall and VPN were owned by the network team; I worked on requests, testing and escalation.	VPN access audit script (lab). Postgrad Diploma in Cybersecurity.	FortiGate administration is new to me. Change tickets, config backup before firmware, logs and alerts.	IAM & Zero Trust lab

Lab projects use synthetic data and are not presented as production deployments. Employer work is described at capability level, with no confidential data.